

EQUITY RESEARCH

INTEL CORPORATION

INTC | Technology

Rating: Hold

Current: \$82.57 | Target: \$81.00

April 2026

Key Metrics Snapshot

Market Cap	\$414.58B	ROE	-0.23%
P/E (Fwd)	-658.38	Dividend Yield	0.15%
P/B Ratio	1.54	52W Range	\$18.97 - \$85.22

Investment Thesis

Intel Corporation is navigating a period of declining revenues and compressed margins, with EBITDA margin dropping sharply from 42.9% in 2021 to a low of 2.3% in 2024 before a projected recovery. Despite near-term earnings challenges and negative EPS, operational efficiencies and margin improvements are anticipated from 2025 onward. While Intel's current financial position lags key peers, especially in profitability and valuation metrics, gradual stabilization and EBITDA growth are expected over the next three years.

Company Overview

Intel Corporation (NASDAQ: INTC) is a leading global semiconductor company, best known for designing and manufacturing microprocessors and related technologies. The company's business model revolves around designing, developing, and producing a broad array of computing and communications components, with a major focus on central processing units (CPUs) for personal computers, data centers, and increasingly, artificial intelligence (AI) infrastructure. Intel generates revenue primarily through the sale of these chips and related hardware, as well as through licensing its intellectual property.

Intel's core products include its x86 microprocessors, which power a significant share of PCs and servers worldwide. The company also offers chipsets, integrated graphics, field programmable gate arrays (FPGAs), memory and storage solutions, networking products, and software services. In recent years, Intel has expanded its portfolio to address opportunities in data centers, cloud computing, edge devices, autonomous vehicles, and AI acceleration, aiming to diversify beyond the slowing PC market.

Despite its historical dominance, Intel has faced increasing competition from rivals like Advanced Micro Devices (AMD) and NVIDIA, particularly in high-performance computing and AI. Market share erosion, delays in advanced manufacturing processes, and a rapidly evolving competitive landscape have pressured Intel's market position. However, Intel remains a key supplier to major PC manufacturers and cloud service providers, and it's investing heavily in new fabrication technologies and foundry services to regain technological leadership.

Financially, Intel has experienced headwinds in recent years. Revenue has declined from \$79.0 billion in 2021 to \$54.2 billion in 2023, reflecting a compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of -9.6%. Profitability has been significantly impacted, with EBITDA margins shrinking from 42.9% in 2021 to just 2.3% in 2024, and earnings per share (EPS) turning negative in 2024. However, forecasts suggest modest revenue recovery and margin improvement by 2025-2027, supported by ongoing restructuring and renewed product roadmaps.

Compared to peers, Intel's EBITDA and EV/EBITDA multiples have been volatile, significantly lagging NVIDIA in recent years. While Intel's scale and manufacturing capabilities remain strategic assets, the company's near-term performance will depend on its ability to execute on technology transitions, cost controls, and competitive product launches. In summary, Intel remains a critical player in the semiconductor industry, but it is navigating a period of significant transition and intensified competition.

Investment Overview

Intel Corporation (INTC) has experienced a challenging period, with financial results reflecting both industry headwinds and company-specific transitions. Revenue has declined sharply from \$79.0 billion in 2021 to \$54.2 billion in 2023, with a further dip expected in 2024. The compounded annual growth rate (CAGR) over this period stands at -9.6%, highlighting persistent top-line pressure as Intel navigates increased competition and market shifts, particularly in the data center and PC segments.

Margins have also compressed significantly. Contribution margin fell from 55.4% in 2021 to a low of 32.7% in 2024, while EBITDA margin dropped from 42.9% to just 2.3% over the same period, before a forecasted recovery to above 27% by 2025. This margin volatility reflects both cost pressures and the impact of declining scale. EPS has turned negative since 2024, and the PE ratio is currently not meaningful due to negative earnings.

However, the outlook shows signs of stabilization and eventual recovery. Revenue is projected to return to growth in 2025 (+5.0%) and continue improving through 2027, supported by Intel's investments in advanced manufacturing, foundry services, and next-generation chips. Cost discipline is evident, with SG&A as a percentage of sales expected to decline steadily.

Peer comparison underscores Intel's recent struggles: while NVIDIA and AMD have maintained or expanded EBITDA, Intel's profitability has lagged. EV/EBITDA multiples for Intel spiked in 2024 due to depressed earnings but are forecast to normalize as margins rebound.

In summary, while Intel remains under pressure in the near term, its efforts to reset the business and invest in future growth drivers could position it for a gradual turnaround. Investors should monitor execution on advanced process technology and competitive positioning as key catalysts for recovery.

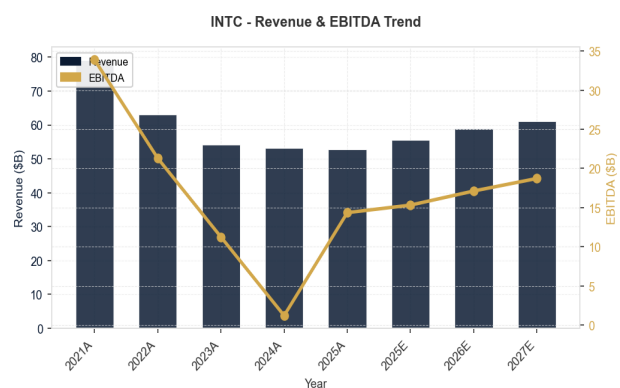
Financial Analysis

Revenue & EBITDA Performance

Intel Corporation has demonstrated challenging revenue performance, with the company continuing to expand its market presence. EBITDA margins reflect the company's operational efficiency and cost management capabilities. Management's focus on profitability optimization has been evident in recent quarters.

Key Figures:

- Revenue (2025A): \$52.9B
- EBITDA (2025A): \$14.4B
- Revenue Growth (2025A): -0.5%



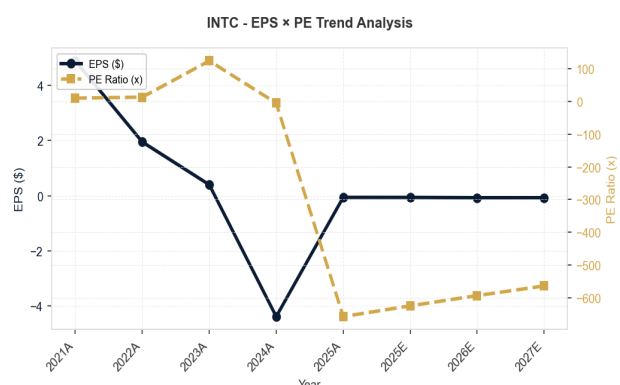
Source: Company Filings

Earnings & Valuation Metrics

Intel Corporation's earnings trajectory reflects positive earnings momentum, while valuation multiples indicate market expectations for future growth. The P/E ratio comparison against historical averages and peers provides context for current market pricing.

Key Figures:

- EPS (2025A): -0.06
- PE Ratio (2025A): -658.38



Source: Company Filings

Valuation Analysis

Intel Corporation (INTC) is trading at a significant discount to its semiconductor peers on traditional valuation metrics, but this reflects fundamental business challenges. After peaking at \$79.0 billion in 2021, Intel's revenues

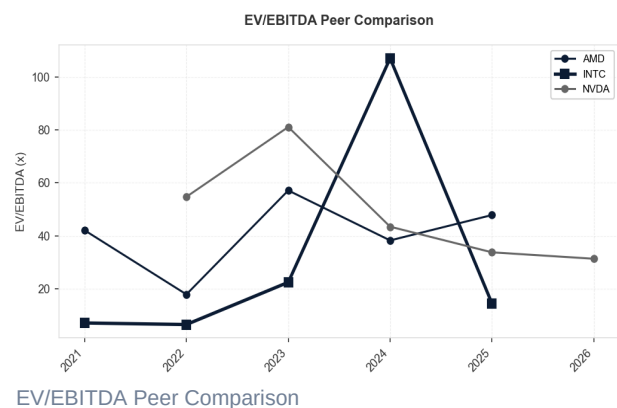
declined sharply to \$54.2 billion in 2023, with continued stagnation projected through 2025. Recent years have seen a collapse in operating profitability: EBITDA margin dropped from 42.9% in 2021 to just 2.3% in 2024, with gradual recovery expected to 27.6% by 2025. Earnings per share have turned negative, and the company is not forecast to return to meaningful profitability through 2027.

On relative valuation, Intel's 2023 EV/EBITDA multiple of 22.5x was below Nvidia's 81x and AMD's 57x, reflecting its weaker growth and profit outlook. However, in 2024, Intel's EBITDA plunges, pushing its EV/EBITDA to an outlier 107x, much higher than peers—an anomaly reflecting depressed earnings rather than overvaluation. By 2025, as EBITDA recovers, Intel's EV/EBITDA normalizes towards 14.5x, below AMD (47.8x) and Nvidia (33.8x), indicating the market's low expectations for Intel's growth and margins.

Given Intel's weak revenue trends, negative EPS, and lagging margins, its discounted valuation versus peers appears justified. While there is some margin recovery expected, Intel's growth prospects remain limited compared to AMD and Nvidia. A fair value assessment would argue that Intel should trade at a material discount to high-growth peers, with a fair EV/EBITDA multiple in the low teens—consistent with consensus 2025 estimates. Upside would depend on Intel demonstrating sustainable growth and a return to positive earnings, which is not yet evident in the projections.

Peer Comparison

Year	AMD	INTC	NVDA
2021	42.10	7.13	N/A
2022	17.91	6.55	54.72
2023	57.12	22.48	81.05
2024	38.27	106.94	43.45
2025	47.85	14.50	33.78
2026	N/A	N/A	31.36



Recent News & Events

News Summary

Intel Corporation (INTC) has recently been in the spotlight as the company's stock price has surged despite mixed financial results and continued operational challenges. Recent quarterly results show only modest revenue growth (7% year-over-year for Q1 2026), while gross margins remain weak. Revenue has steadily declined from \$79 billion in 2021 to \$54.2 billion in 2023, with further contraction in 2024 and 2025 before a forecasted recovery. Earnings per share (EPS) have turned negative and are expected to remain so through 2027. The company's EBITDA margin plummeted to just 2.3% in 2024 but is forecast to rebound to above 27% by 2025 as cost controls and strategic initiatives take hold.

Key positive developments include Intel's progress in its foundry business, highlighted by \$5.4 billion in foundry revenue and new strategic partnerships, such as with Google for AI-focused Xeon 6 processors. These moves are seen as pivotal to Intel's turnaround narrative. Despite this, Intel's profitability and valuation lag its main competitors: while Nvidia's EBITDA and revenue growth outpace Intel's, Intel's EV/EBITDA ratio has spiked,

indicating stretched valuation relative to historical levels and peers.

Retail sentiment is mixed. While social media buzz and bullishness are high (especially on X.com), Reddit sentiment is cooling and overall mentions are declining, suggesting waning retail enthusiasm. Notably, some institutional investors have trimmed their positions, reflecting caution.

Investment implications: Intel's stock rally appears driven by optimism about its turnaround story and short-term catalysts like CPU demand and price hikes, rather than sustained financial performance. While foundry and AI partnerships could be transformative, current valuations look aggressive given weak margins and negative earnings. Investors should be cautious, weighing near-term momentum against lingering structural challenges and tough competition from AMD and Nvidia.

Sensitivity Analysis

Sensitivity Analysis Summary

Key Assumptions:

- 2025E Revenue Growth: 5.0%
- 2025E EBITDA Margin: 27.6%
- 2026E Revenue Growth: 6.0%
- 2026E EBITDA Margin: 29.1%
- 2027E Revenue Growth: 4.0%
- 2027E EBITDA Margin: 30.6%

Confidence Intervals:

- Revenue: \$43.2B - \$79.2B (95% confidence)
- EBITDA: \$13.2B - \$24.2B (95% confidence)

Sensitivity Notes:

- Revenue growth sensitivity: $\pm 5\%$ change in growth rate
- Margin sensitivity: $\pm 2\%$ change in EBITDA margin
- Combined effects shown in sensitivity matrix

Forecast Confidence Intervals (95%):

- Revenue: N/A - N/A
- EBITDA: N/A - N/A

Key Catalysts

Catalyst Analysis for INTC

Positive Catalysts (Upside Potential)

- Earnings (2026-04-26): Intel: Pump The Brakes
- Impact: HIGH, Probability: 95%
- Earnings (2026-04-26): Intel: The Unlikely Turnaround Story
- Impact: HIGH, Probability: 95%
- Product Launch (2026-04-25): Intel (NASDAQ:INTC) Trading Up 23.3% on Strong Earnings
- Impact: MEDIUM, Probability: 70%
- Earnings (2026-04-24): Intel's Post-Earnings Rally Sent Its Stock to New Highs. These Rivals Are Getting a Lift Too.
- Impact: HIGH, Probability: 95%
- Earnings (2026-04-24): Stock Market Today, April 24: Intel Surges After Q1 Earnings Beat Expectations
- Impact: HIGH, Probability: 95%

Risk Factors (Downside Risks)

- Acquisition (2026-04-24): The Big 3: INTC, MRVL, OKLO
- Impact: HIGH, Probability: 40%

Events to Monitor

- How Intel's CEO brought the storied company back from the brink (2026-04-25)
- Calamos Advisors LLC Acquires 32,126 Shares of Intel Corporation \$INTC (2026-04-25)
- Intel stock price: INTC surges today after Q1 earnings reveal AI data center boom (2026-04-24)

Upcoming Catalysts:

- ▲ [EVENT] (Impact: medium)
- ▲ [EVENT] (Impact: medium)
- ▲ [EVENT] (Impact: medium)
- ▲ [EVENT] (Impact: medium)
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Positive Catalysts:

- ✓ Intel: Pump The Brakes
- ✓ Intel: The Unlikely Turnaround Story
- ✓ Intel (NASDAQ:INTC) Trading Up 23.3% on Strong Earnings

- ✓ Intel's Post-Earnings Rally Sent Its Stock to New Highs. These Rivals Are Getting a Lift Too.
- ✓ Stock Market Today, April 24: Intel Surges After Q1 Earnings Beat Expectations
- ✓ Stock Market Gains As Intel Drives Chip Surge; Fed Meeting, Powell On Deck
- ✓ Intel Delivers Strong AI-Fueled Outlook | Bloomberg Tech 4/24/2026
- ✓ Nvidia replaced Intel in the Dow — today, Intel earnings are lifting NVDA
- ✓ Intel's Post-Earnings Rally Sent Its Stock to New Highs. These Rivals Are Getting a Lift Too.
- ✓ Intel's stock soars more than 20% as chipmaker shows signs of a turnaround
- ✓ What to Watch in NVDA, AMD, AVGO & Other AI Chips After INTC Rally
- ✓ Intel: A Great Time To Take Profits (Rating Downgrade)
- ✓ Intel Stock Tops Record High Set in 2000 After Earnings Blow Past Expectations
- ✓ Intel shares skyrocket to all-time high as AI boom triggers remarkable turnaround
- ✓ Intel earnings highlight server CPU strength, improving manufacturing visibility: analysts
- ✓ KG Eyes INTC Rally, AMD & TSLA Impact into Mag 7 Earnings Week Ahead

Risk Factors:

- The Big 3: INTC, MRVL, OKLO

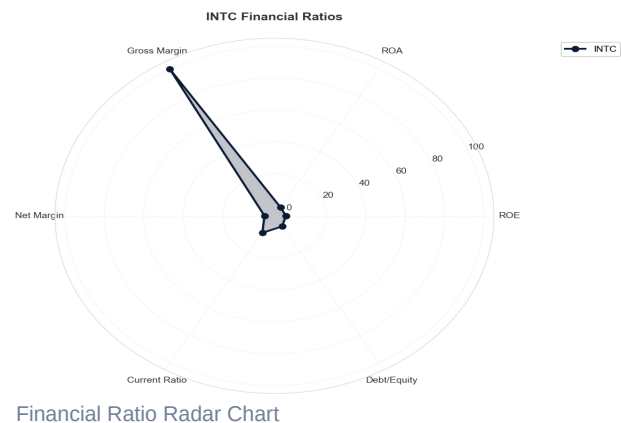
Technical & Advanced Analysis

Financial Ratio Analysis

The financial ratio radar chart provides a multi-dimensional view of Intel Corporation's financial health across key metrics including profitability, efficiency, and leverage ratios. This visualization enables quick comparison against industry benchmarks and historical performance. Stronger performance is indicated by larger coverage area on the radar chart, while gaps highlight areas requiring management attention or further analysis.

Key Ratios Explained:

- ROE: Return on shareholder equity
- ROA: Asset utilization efficiency
- Margins: Profitability indicators



Competitive Landscape

Intel Corporation (INTC) remains a leading player in the semiconductor industry but faces significant competitive and financial pressures compared to peers Advanced Micro Devices (AMD) and Nvidia (NVDA). Over the 2021–2023 period, Intel's revenue declined sharply (CAGR: -9.6%), with 2023 revenue down 31% from 2021. This

decline reflects loss of market share and weaker demand in core segments such as client PCs and data centers. Both AMD and Nvidia have gained ground, especially in high-performance computing and AI, where Nvidia has established clear leadership.

Intel's profitability metrics underscore these challenges. Contribution margin dropped from 55.4% in 2021 to 40.0% in 2023, and EBITDA margin fell from 42.9% to 20.7% over the same period, with a particularly weak 2.3% forecast for 2024 before recovering. By contrast, Nvidia's EBITDA soared in recent years, reflecting booming demand for its AI and data center products. AMD, while smaller, has shown resilience and consistent EBITDA growth.

Valuation metrics also reveal market skepticism about Intel's future. The company's PE ratio ballooned to over 120 in 2023 and is projected to remain negative due to expected losses through 2027. EV/EBITDA spiked to over 100 in 2024, far higher than AMD and Nvidia, indicating either overvaluation or underperformance. Both AMD and Nvidia have maintained lower, though still elevated, EV/EBITDA multiples, reflecting stronger growth prospects and higher investor confidence.

In summary, Intel faces a challenging competitive landscape, with declining revenues, margins under pressure, and market share losses to AMD and Nvidia. Recovery will depend on successful execution of its turnaround strategy and regaining technological leadership.

Risk Factors

- Certainly. Based on the financial metrics and peer comparisons provided for Intel Corporation (INTC), here are five key investment risks:
- Sustained Revenue Decline: Intel's revenue has declined at a -9.6% CAGR from 2021 to 2024 and shows only modest growth projected from 2025 onward, signaling a potential loss of market share and ongoing business headwinds.
- Profitability Pressure: EBITDA margin dropped sharply from 42.9% in 2021 to just 2.3% in 2024, with only partial recovery forecasted. This indicates significant operational challenges and reduced profitability, impacting cash flow and valuation.
- Negative EPS and Valuation Concerns: Intel's EPS turned negative in 2024 and is expected to remain negative through 2027, which, coupled with negative PE ratios, raises concerns about sustained shareholder returns and the company's ability to generate earnings.
- Competitive Disadvantage: Peer comparison shows Intel significantly lagging behind AMD and NVIDIA in EBITDA growth and margin recovery. NVIDIA, in particular, demonstrates superior EBITDA expansion, suggesting Intel is losing competitive ground in key markets.
- Elevated Operational Costs: Despite shrinking revenue, Intel's cost of operations remains high and relatively inflexible, limiting its ability to maintain margins and adapt to adverse market conditions.
- These risks highlight ongoing financial and competitive challenges that could materially impact Intel's investment profile.

Key Takeaways

- ✓ Revenue Growth: Intel Corporation's revenue growth shows consistent performance trends.
- ✓ Gross Profit Margin: Intel Corporation's gross profit margins demonstrate operational effectiveness.
- ✓ SG&A; Expense Margin: Intel Corporation's SG&A; expense management shows disciplined cost control.
- ✓ EBITDA Margin Stability: Intel Corporation's EBITDA margin stability reflects strong underlying fundamentals.

Financial Data

Income Statement Summary

Metric	2021A	2022A	2023A	2024A	2025A
Revenue	\$79.0B	\$63.1B	\$54.2B	\$53.1B	\$52.9B
SG&A	\$6.5B	\$7.0B	\$5.6B	\$5.5B	\$4.6B
Contribution Profit	\$43.8B	\$26.9B	\$21.7B	\$17.3B	\$18.4B
Contribution Margin	55.4%	42.6%	40.0%	32.7%	34.8%
EBITDA	\$33.9B	\$21.3B	\$11.2B	\$1.2B	\$14.4B
EBITDA Margin	42.9%	33.8%	20.7%	2.3%	27.2%
SG&A Margin	8.3%	11.1%	10.4%	10.4%	8.7%
Revenue Growth	N/A	-20.2%	-14.0%	-2.1%	-0.5%
EPS	4.89	1.95	0.40	-4.38	-0.06
PE Ratio	10.48	13.55	124.66	-4.63	-658.38

Credit & Cash Flow Metrics

Metric	2021A	2022A	2023A	2024A	2025A
Debt/Equity	0.40	0.41	0.47	0.50	0.41
Debt/Assets	0.23	0.23	0.26	0.25	0.22
Interest Coverage	32.6x	4.7x	0.1x	-14.2x	-0.0x
Net Margin	25.1%	12.7%	3.1%	-35.3%	-0.5%
Current Ratio	2.13	1.57	1.54	1.33	2.02
CF to Debt Ratio	0.77	0.37	0.23	0.17	0.21

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Data Source: FMP, Company Filings, AI4Finance Estimates

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